

TALE OF TWO CITIES
Bedroom (left); bathroom (below far left); staircase (below left) and living space (bottom) from a Delhi villa project; the blue bedroom (below); and triple height courtyard (right) from a Dubai villa project









Talk to Zarir about luxury and you won't hear about gold leaf or Italian marble. He'll talk about the way light hits a floor at 4 PM or how a room feels when it's silent. "True luxury is space and proportion," he says. It's a hard sell in an industry that loves flashy, but they don't argue with clients. Instead, they show them. They use their drawings to demonstrate how a flashy feature might feel exhausting after five years, while a well-placed window or a double-height volume only gets better with time.

There is a pragmatism to how they work; the design language changes as quickly as the zip code. So, in the vertical crush of Mumbai, they design homes that act as filters, using screens and decks to keep the chaos at arm's length. Move to Dubai, however, and the walls practically disappear, allowing courtyards to become the social heart of the home.